

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article and Letter to the Editor appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Fair fine?

A 71-year-old Hong Kong cleaning employee, working at Southorn Playground, was fined HK\$1,500 for throwing waste water on a street on Monday by the Food and Environmental Hygiene Department.

However, after a number of newspaper and TV reports about her fine for littering, her employer Baguio Cleaning Services Company has decided to pay the fine for her.

"I was scared I would have to pay it by myself," Zhou said, adding it would be very expensive as she only earns HK\$8,300 a month.

Equal penalties for those who break the rules

I cannot accept the actions of an elderly cleaner dumping waste water in a street in Wan Chai or her employer paying the fine for her.

Just because someone is underprivileged does not mean they should not be punished if they have done something wrong, in this case emptying waste water in the street. If she broke regulations then she should have accepted the punishment. If she was struggling to pay the fine, then she could have been given more time to pay it.

We all have to be responsible for our actions and recognise the importance of cracking down on pollution on our streets.

We have to recognise that all stakeholders have to play their part in ensuring society is orderly and that we all stick to the necessary rules.

Kris Lam, Sham Shui Po

You have been asked to discuss whether fines and penalties are an effective way to keep Hong Kong streets clean. You may want to talk about:

- whether the elderly cleaner should have been fined
- whether fines and penalties stop people littering
- any problems that fines and penalties cause
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you think there is a lot of litter in Hong Kong?
2. What do you do if there is no bin for your rubbish?
3. Why do you think that people litter?
4. Are there other ways to stop people littering?
5. Do you agree that throwing water on the street is littering?
6. Are fines a suitable way to stop anti-social behaviour?
7. Does government advertising stop people littering?
8. Should rich people pay the same fines as poor people?